

Committee Member Guide

WRAC Research Funding Portal

Washington State Wine Commission — Research Advisory Committee

Website: <https://wrac-portal.vercel.app/>

How to sign in, review proposals, and submit your scores.

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What this portal is

This is where the Research Advisory Committee reviews and scores research proposals. As a committee member you decide which proposals you are able to review, read each one, score it against a set of questions, and leave comments.

Your review is private to you—no other reviewer sees your scores or comments, and you don't see theirs. Only the program manager sees everyone's reviews together.

Signing in the first time

You don't register yourself—the program manager creates your account and gives you a temporary password.

- 1 Go to <https://wrac-portal.vercel.app/> in any web browser.
- 2 Sign in with your email and the temporary password the manager gave you.
- 3 You'll be asked to set your own new password before you can continue. Choose one you'll remember.
- 4 After that, you sign in normally with your email and new password.

If you lose your password

Contact the program manager—they can reset it and give you a new temporary one.

Your home screen

When you sign in you see your review dashboard: one card for each active cycle, showing its review deadline, how many days remain, and how many reviews you have submitted out of the number waiting for you.

Within each cycle, proposals are grouped by what kind they are, with a count beside each heading:

- **Pre-proposals** — short outlines, reviewed early in the cycle.
- **Full proposals** — complete applications from pre-proposals that were advanced.
- **Continuations** — requests for the next year's funding on an ongoing project.

- **Off-cycle** — proposals funded from a separate source, outside the annual round.

Only the groups with something in them appear. A cycle taking pre-proposal reviews shows one group, not four. If two cycles are open in different phases, the grouping is what tells them apart at a glance.

What the labels on each proposal mean

Not yet decided	You haven't said whether you'll review this one. It needs your attention.
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Reviewing	You've opted in and started, or have yet to start, your scoring.
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Submitted	Your review is in and locked.
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Reopened	The program manager reopened your review so you can change it.
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Declined	You've opted out of this proposal. It stays visible but greyed out.
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Choosing whether to review

This has changed. Reviewing is no longer split evenly across the whole committee by default. You now decide, proposal by proposal, whether you are the right person to review it.

When you open a proposal you haven't yet decided on, you'll be asked **Will you review this proposal?** with two choices:

- **Yes, I'll review** — the scoring form opens and the proposal counts toward your outstanding reviews.
- **No, I'll decline** — you are removed from that proposal's scoring. You won't count toward its total or its maximum possible score, and it no longer counts as something you owe.

The scoring form does not appear until you opt in. Decline when a proposal is outside your expertise, or where you would rather not score it—a review from someone poorly placed to judge the work is worth less than no review at all.

Changing your mind

You can switch either way, as often as you like, right up until you submit.

- If you opted in, a link below the scoring form lets you decline instead.
- If you declined, a button on the proposal lets you take it back on.

Declining never deletes scores you have already entered. They simply stop counting, and count again if you opt back in.

Once you submit, the choice is fixed

After you submit a review you can no longer change whether you were reviewing that proposal. If you need to, ask the program manager to reopen it for you—then you can change your scores or decline.

What declining does to your counts

A declined proposal is taken out of the number waiting for you on that cycle's card. If you decline the last one outstanding, the card shows **All in**. A proposal you haven't decided on yet still counts as outstanding—so the honest way to clear your list is to open each one and choose, not to leave the ones you can't judge untouched.

Reviewing a proposal

Once you've opted in, the page gives you two things side by side: the proposal itself to read, and your scoring form to fill in.

Reading the proposal

- You'll see the project title, the researcher and their institution, the amount requested, and the multi-year plan if it's a multi-year project.
- The uploaded documents each have a View link that opens the file (the narrative, budget, CV, and so on).
- For a continuation of an ongoing project, you can open the original application and see the project's full reporting history—so you know what was promised and what's been delivered.

Scoring

- 1 For each question, enter a score within the allowed range shown, and write a comment.
- 2 Your work saves as a draft—you can stop and come back before the deadline.
- 3 A running total shows your scores as you go.
- 4 When you've answered every question, submit your review.

Once you submit

Your review locks. If you need to change it after submitting, ask the program manager to reopen it for you. You can't submit until every question has a score—the portal will tell you if any are missing.

Your reviews are private

This matters, so it's worth repeating: each committee member reviews independently. You will never see another member's scores or comments, and they will never see yours. Only the program manager sees all reviews together, in order to summarize them for the funding discussion.

Score honestly—your individual view is exactly what's wanted. The same applies to declining: opting out of a proposal you aren't placed to judge is a useful signal, not a failure to participate.

Deadlines

Each cycle has a review deadline, shown on your home screen with the days remaining. Try to complete your reviews by then so the committee can move to its funding discussion.

If you're running late you can still submit—the portal does not cut you off at the deadline—but the sooner the better for the whole committee, since the funding meeting works from the scores that are in.

Getting help

If a document won't open, you can't submit, or you need a review reopened, contact the program manager.

Use the **Need help?** link at the top of any page, or email **JTarara@washingtonwine.org** directly.